multinational corporations like Unilever or General Motors (before the economic meltdown of 2008 after which they have filed for bankruptcy) but also account for the activities of separatist ethnic organizations such as the Irish Republican Army (IRA) in Ulster, Palestinian Liberation Organization (PLO) and others and would also include the activities of individuals and non-governmental organizations having a powerful transnational impact such as the Green Peace, Amnesty International, the Roman Catholic Church and others. This, obviously, in no way undermines the importance of the states and their governments as they are still treated as extremely important international actors but are no longer the only actors.[25] The increasing presence of non-state actors must be admitted.

Holsti refers to three kinds of non-state actors:

- Territorial non-state actors
- Non-territorial non-state actors
- Inter-governmental actors.

Frankel also recognizes the existence of mainly three categories of non-state actors:

- Inter-state governmental organizations
- Inter-state non-governmental actors
- Intranational actors.

Following Frankel we will now discuss about these three non-state actors.

Inter-State Governmental Organizations (IGOs)

IGOs are important non-state actors in world politics. They are formed when several states come together in some common interest. These organizations most often develop a common external policy that might at times contravene the interests of any single member state.